

Reflective Journal: Module 2

This lab was mostly about getting set up and trying out the basic tools. I loaded the Iris dataset, put it in a Pandas DataFrame, and made a scatter plot and a bar chart. I also found the mean and standard deviation of sepal length with NumPy.

What stuck with me most was the scatter plot. Looking at the table of numbers, I couldn't really tell anything. After I plotted it, I could see that setosa is off by itself and the other two species are mixed together. So plotting the data first seems like a good habit before doing anything else with it. It also made me wonder if the petal measurements would separate versicolor and virginica better.

I already use Colab and Pandas in my NLP class, so most of the setup was a little easy for me. I didn't expect the workflow to be almost the same for numbers as it is for text, it is about loading the data, look at it, then plot it.

The hard part was the written observations. Describing what's in the plot was a bit easy, but explaining why the two species overlap and what that means for a model took me a while. I also kept writing too much and had to cut it down. Next I will upload this notebook to my GitHub repository. In the next module I want to try a simple classifier and see if it can tell versicolor and virginica apart.